



CAR SALES ZOOM

India's passenger vehicle sales grew 8% year-on-year (YoY) to hit a record high of 4.7 million units in the financial year 2025-26, compared with 4.3 million units in the previous fiscal, according to industry estimates. Despite a muted first half, the industry witnessed strong double-digit growth

following the GST rate cut. While Maruti Suzuki maintained its pole position, the biggest gainers were homegrown carmakers—Mahindra & Mahindra and Tata Motors. They overtook Korea's Hyundai Motor India to become second-largest and third-largest, respectively, by volume.

12.48%

YOY SURGE IN OUTPUT OF CAPITAL GOODS IN FEBRUARY 2026. IT EMERGED AS THE TOP PERFORMER IN INDIA'S INDEX OF INDUSTRIAL PRODUCTION DATA, WHICH SHOWED OVERALL INDUSTRIAL GROWTH OF 5.23%



OIL TAKES A TOLL

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Surging global crude oil prices that have touched multi-year highs have led to the Centre stepping in to provide duty concessions to critical sectors and consumers. It cut the excise duty on petrol and diesel by ₹10 per litre on March 27, followed by a three-month waiver of customs duty on 40 petrochemicals and a concessional customs duty regime of sales by SEZs to domestic tariff areas. The relief measures are likely to hit the exchequer with revenue losses estimated at over ₹1.5 lakh crore this fiscal. Consumers seem to be protected for now; the ceasefire announcement can bring some temporary respite.

LAY-OFFS AT ORACLE

Thousands of Oracle employees in India woke up to termination emails at 6 AM—no prior meetings, no HR calls. The company cut around 30,000 jobs globally, including 10,000–12,000 in India—about 40% of its local workforce. The lay-offs are said to be driven by the company's investment in AI infrastructure. Since 2025, TCS has also laid off around 12,000 employees, but in phases. In contrast, Oracle's lay-offs rank among the largest job cuts India's tech sector has seen, executed in a single day.

